

1.4 The 1990s—Rise Of The New Machines

In the 1990s, the gaming industry developed into gargantuan proportions. Budgets were increasing at a fast clip and a number of small publishers were being snapped up by the bigger players. There was an increase in the consolidation of



DOOM defined the First Person Shooter (FPS) genre

game publishers, and the gaming industry started acquiring a Hollywood-style image. Here the stars were the game characters. This rise in the budgets in games was directly linked to the increase in computing power and the dramatic fall in the prices of processors such as the Intel 486 and the Motorola 68000.

The 1990s saw massive developments in 3D graphics technology and multimedia capabilities. The PC was fast replacing the console as a preferred gaming device.

In the early 1990s, smaller developers preferred publishing their games by distributing shareware copies of their games. This gave the user a chance to try out a new game by playing part of it and then deciding whether or not he wanted to buy the entire game. Typically, shareware versions of games were distributed on single floppies.

This method soon ran into practical difficulties as the size of the games started increasing. Fitting the larger games onto floppies seemed impossible, and the reliability of the media, too, posed a major problem. This gave rise to the practice of handing